

7 Search, Chat and GPS

7.1 Search

Your Android phone can do all kinds of neat things with its comprehensive access to the web allowing you to search for information on your phone as well as items on the internet using Google search. The Search button opens a box similar to the one on the search engine which characterises Google on the web. You can either type a search query or use the Voice search option instead. To further fasten the process, previously searched items are displayed below the search box. While going through applications like Gmail or Contacts, the application's own search box, identifiable by the app's own icon, opens on pressing Search. You can even add a dedicated Search widget on the Home Screen to search in a particular place like just on the web or a specific application's information on the phone. On touching a dedicated Search widget on your Home Screen, Google search is opened with that location targeted by default.

As you type a search keyword, matching items on your phone and suggestions from Google web search are added to the list of previously chosen search results. Touching the pencil symbol next to a suggestion includes it in the search box and makes way for more suggestions. Touching the suggestion itself opens the item in its appropriate location, like on a browser window or in the Contacts. Business listings are indicated by the familiar balloon shaped Maps marker icon and touching one opens a panel with icons you can touch to call or get details or to add to your contacts.

At first the Google search box is configured to search and provide suggestions from the web and the phone but this can be modified to target searches only to the web or to a single application on the phone. The icon on the left of the search box can be pressed to open a panel with icons for all applications that have been checked in the Searchable items settings so as to include not only Web and contacts but also other apps such as music or installed features such as Twitter and Google Sky. Thus you can easily narrow your searches onto the most used applications. Android gives you various options to cut make your searching most effective though the Search Settings in Menu. You can check or uncheck the kinds of data you want to search for on your phone, erase previously chosen lists of search results that appear as suggestions, include your location when using Google services, manage a web based interface for viewing and sorting through search